

TOPIC 5: RULES OF MADD (PROLONGATION)

1. Meaning of Madd

Madd means prolongation or lengthening of the sound of a letter. In Tajwid, it refers to lengthening the vowel sound of Alif, Waw or Ya under specific conditions. Correct Madd preserves the meaning and beauty of the Qur'an.

2. Letters of Madd

The three letters of Madd are: Alif (ا) after Fatha, Waw (و) after Damma, Ya (ي) after Kasra. These are the natural Madd letters when they are silent (no vowel of their own) and preceded by the matching short vowel.

3. Types of Madd (Basic)

- **Madd Asli / Tabee'i (Natural Madd)** – lengthened 2 counts when a Madd letter is not followed by a Hamzah or Sukoon. Example: قَالَا (qaala).
- **Madd Far'i (Secondary Madd)** – occurs when a Madd letter is followed by Hamzah or Sukoon; length varies (e.g. 4 or 5 counts for connected Madd, 6 for necessary Madd in some cases). Sub-types include Madd Muttasil, Madd Munfasil, Madd Lazim, Madd 'Arid lis-Sukoon.

4. Application in Recitation

Listen carefully to a qualified reciter, count the beats of the prolongation, and practise until the length is consistent. Do not over-lengthen or under-lengthen.

5. Summary

Madd is the lengthening of vowel sounds according to fixed rules. Mastering Madd Asli and the main types of Madd Far'i is essential for correct Qur'anic recitation.

End of Topic 5